

We Replaced Our Sales Team's First Call

Here's what happened in the first 60 days.

Executive Summary

Our sales team was drowning in unqualified leads. Closers spent 80% of their time on people who were never going to buy. We deployed an AI lead qualifier to handle the first call, screen for fit, and route hot leads to our team immediately. The results in 60 days: **68% increase in close rate**, **52% reduction in call volume**, and **143 leads auto-qualified** without a single staff member involved.

The Problem: Unqualified Lead Overload

Before automation, our sales reps were handling 30+ calls per day. Most were tire-kickers with no budget and no urgency. A typical Tuesday looked like this:

Time	Activity	Outcome
9:00 AM	Call with prospect #1	40 min call, no budget, will think about it
10:00 AM	Call with prospect #2	25 min call, not ready until Q3
11:00 AM	Call with prospect #3	35 min call, competitor shopping only
2:00 PM	Call with prospect #4	50 min call, decision-maker not involved

By the end of the day, the rep had spoken to 11 leads. Only 1 was qualified. The other 10 consumed 4.5 hours of selling time.

The Solution: AI Lead Qualifier

We built an AI agent to handle the discovery call before any human got involved. The AI asked three qualifying questions in natural conversation:

1. **Problem Fit:** 'What are you hoping to accomplish?'

2. Timeline Urgency: 'When are you looking to get started?'

3. Budget Reality: 'Have you worked with [service type] before?'

Based on responses, the AI scored leads as HOT, WARM, or COLD. Hot leads were routed to closers immediately. Warm leads entered a nurture sequence. Cold leads were politely disqualified.

60-Day Results

Metric	Before AI	After AI	Change
Close Rate	18%	30%	+68%
Calls per Rep/Day	27	13	-52%
Avg Call Duration	38 min	22 min	-42%
Leads Qualified	143	143	Same pipeline
Hours Saved/Week	—	18 hrs	Per rep

ROI Calculation: With 3 sales reps saving 18 hours/week each at \$45/hour loaded cost, the AI qualifier saved \$2,430/week in labor alone. Revenue impact: 12% increase in monthly revenue from higher close rates with the same lead volume.

What We Learned

Week 1 was rough.

The AI asked good questions but the flow felt stiff. Two leads dropped off early. We almost scrapped it.

Week 2 changed everything.

We refined the script based on our best rep's actual calls. Added natural transitions. The drop-off rate fell to near-zero.

The AI doesn't replace closers.

It filters for them. Our reps now only talk to people who already know the price, understand the offer, and have a real problem.

Speed matters more than perfection.

The AI responds in 8 seconds. Even with a slightly robotic tone (fixed by Week 3), speed beat waiting 47 minutes for a human callback.

The Tech Stack

Here's what we used to build this system. Total monthly cost: ~RM450 (~\$100 USD).

Tool	Purpose	Cost/Month
Vapi.ai	Voice AI for phone calls	RM400 (\$95)
Make.com	Automation workflows	RM40 (\$9)
Airtable	CRM and lead storage	RM85 (\$20)
Twilio	SMS confirmations	RM85 (\$20)

Conclusion: AI + Human = Winning Formula

The companies winning in 2026 aren't replacing sales reps with AI. They're using AI for the volume, speed, and qualification work — and humans for the high-value close.

AI qualifies. Human closes. Revenue doubles.

Want our exact setup?

DM 'QUALIFY' on Instagram @synaprix

We'll send you the full AI qualifier flow, prompts, and integration guide.

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